CHCCA 2019 Annual Meeting Minutes

Location: Cottage 19

Date: October 12, 2019

Facilitator: Lynn Bowman

Minutes: Judy Pachter

Attachments: Corn Hill Cottage October 18-Sept 2019 Special Projects report (attachment 1); Peters Property Management Report (attachment 2); CHCCA FY 20 Approved Budget (attachment 3)

Attendees: Susan and Joe Rothstein, Margaret Grierson, Lynn Bowman, Patty Spencer, Adam Hunt, Liz Tavares, Laurie Hutcheson, Nancy Ide, Judy Pachter **Call in**: Brice and Michelle McKane

Absent: Shirley Wright and Amy Cerel

Guests: Jon and Christina Spencer, Rachel Pachter, Jerimiah Hill, Kate Hunt & Joslyn Bonfini (Peter's Property Management).

Meeting called to order by Lynn at 9:30 AM

Attendance/Introductions/voting Owners & Proxy designations

Cottage #	Voting/Owner	Proxy
5	Spencer	
6	Tavares (et al)	
7	Bowman	
8	McKane	
9	Pachter	
10	Ide	
11	Gillease (deceased)	Lynn Bowman
12	Wright	Margaret Grierson
18	Grierson	
19	Rothstein (et al)	
8 SLW	Hutcheson (et al)	
9 SLW	Cerel	Lynn Bowman
10 SLW	Hunt (et al)	

Review 2018 Minutes

Motion was made to accept and approve the 2018 CHCCA annual meeting minutes. Motion passed.

Summary of 2018-2019 Completed Projects (Margaret-attachment 1)

The special project budget was 10K. A total of 16K was spent on special projects. Please see the attached special projects report for detail.

The following projects were completed:

- Parking area enhancements
- Laundry Shed retaining wall
- Cottage 10 SLW landscaping
- Outdoor shower enclosure
- Storage room re-siding

The following projects were completed and funded through reserve allocations:

- Beach staircase repairs
- Storage room roof replacements

A total of 20K was allocated from reserves and a total of 22K was spent on the projects highlighted above. Margaret provided a detailed explanation of the unfavorable variance to the budgeted amounts. Adam brought up the size of the shower enclosure and thought it was excessive. Lynn explained that it had to be tied into the retaining wall for stability.

Peters Property Management Report (Joslyn Bonfini- see attachment 2)

Joslyn reviewed the 2019 completed projects and recommended future projects for the Association to review. Joslyn requested that special requests for shut down of individual cottages get into Peters ASAP

Discussion:

- Lighting timers need to be checked more often. Adam brought up the timer that is in their cottage. Also, too much light down on second landing way. Maybe use sensors instead of timers.
- Liz asked to explain what is included in routine maintenance. Joslyn reviewed the safety and security checks that are part of routine maintenance. Action Item: Lynn will send Liz a copy of the Peters' contract
- There are ongoing concerns about how often to trim vegetation around grill area. Decision: Peters to trim the entire grill area to prevent any fire hazard
- Adam brought up propane on shutdown. Action Item: Lynn will meet with Adam to ensure propane is not turned off for the Association if and when Adam closes his cottage.
- Lynn requested that Joslyn follow up with individual owners to discuss repair and maintenance recommendations

Corn Hill Cottage Chair Report (Lynn)

- Outdoor Shower is complete. Lock is broken. Action Item: Lynn will fix lock
- Laundry room has been used a lot without any issues and everyone is happy to have laundry room! Many thanks to Adam and Kate for supporting the Laundry Shed project. Action item: Lynn will create sign to remind folks to turn off laundry room lights.
- Parking Permits: The parking coupon/permits seemed to work well. No complaints about parking this year. At times there were too many cars in front of 12 SLW. The Trustees recommend that coupons/permits should continue next year. Kate said that people were sometimes not using them. Folks agreed that the parking coupons were helpful in creating the awareness needed to highlight our parking constraints. Recommendation was made that owners laminate the permits for next year. Susan said Nessa was rarely here this summer so no complaints. Lynn emphasized that no one owns any parking spots. We now have 26 spaces and every owner/renter should be able to find parking. It is important that owners reinforce with renters that they have two parking spots. No exceptions will be made.
- Insurance Renewal: Lynn successfully renewed all policies without increase and moved all renewal dates to coincide with the beginning of our fiscal year 10/1.
- Unruly renters: A few issues arose during the high season. Lynn encouraged owners to reinforce our policies and procedures for renters. Owners should contact other owners if they observe unruly behavior so that owners have an opportunity to address the unruly behaviors with their renters.
- Cottage 11 update: Janet Gillease passed away. Cottage is on the market. The listing agent is Duarte Downey.
- Cottage closing date: November 4 (does not apply to Hunts).

Committee Reports

Electrical Infrastructure: (Brice) - We have a very old system. Increasing load and demand. Eversource owns the line and dictates what you can connect and they have approved contractors –Tim Farrell. He has to do the work. Tim Brady- has to create a site plan-$ 5500 to $7500 for the plan, and then $1500 for permit/application fee to Eversource to upgrade. $44-55K to do install the upgrade. To do whole upgrade - $59,000. Might be able to move forward with this plan on a partial basis. Need to table this because we do not have the money right now. Question about our safety- yes, we do (?do have safety issues?). Rachel- Is there a loan program of some sort available that might help with costs? Laundry shed is on a separate line. These costs don't include upgrading of individual fuse boxes. Does cost include any individual work on cottages? Brice does not know. People should make sure their own cottages are safe.

Governance: (Susan) Officers, term limits, Susan took a condominium course. Summarize- don't need to revise documents. We can operate under old ones. Other issue is percent of ownership and it was done at the time of conversion. Cannot change that unless docs change. Susan thinks that it is inequitable. Term limits not feasible. Not necessary to have other officers. Lynn- vote- should we change to equal voting rights? Susan and Laura think that they are tied together. Lynn agreed. So, should we change the way things are done? We will need to have a committee to see if we want to change this. 3 things are involved: percent of ownerships, vote equality, and condo fees. Can we pull these things apart? Changes to common areas and documents now need a vote by percent of ownership. Suggestion made to Susan that the Governance Committee explore the question of equalizing voting and condo fees.

Building Materials- (Judy) Nancy said sometimes we can't get the old stuff. We all want to use materials that would last and not have as much maintenance. Margaret pointed out that sometimes what we have is sometimes better than replacement. Upkeeps might be important. Composite material- decking, posts?? IPE- very expensive but very durable. Bring it to the trustees. Can't be an individual cottage owner's decision. Laurie- Insurance claim may dictate how you do it. Have more efficient more durable products. Recommendations on composite shutters. Decking windows and shutters are the things that we need to look at. Committee will continue to work on that. Committee: Judy, Nancy, Laurie and Damon. Recommendations will be made to the Trustee by the spring.

New Business

Fox- Nancy reported that animal control said to do nothing about the fox. Use a spray water bottle or hose to deter the fox from encroaching on porches/walkways.

Landscaping- Owners agreed that the all of the vegetation around the grill area should be kept closely, trimmed. **Action:** Lynn to inform Peters of decision

Air Conditioners- not allowed- vote carried.

Window fans—not allowed- vote carried. Table fans are permitted.

Renter minimum length of stay- currently we do not have any restrictions on minimum length of stays. Question: Should we institute one? As we use short term rentals, it is like a revolving door. Trustees recommend that we have 7 day minimum stay from June 1 to September 15th. **Discussion**: Margaret commented that some people discover us through Air BnB. Then they become long term renters. Brice thinks that if we institute a minimum length of stay that we only do it in July and August only. Liz- She is on Air BnB and listed the cottage as a seven day stay and was not able to generate any renters. Liz is not in favor of the restriction. Susan- some family or friends come for just a couple of days. AirBnB is not the only way to find renters. Should there be some kind of clearing house where renters can look? Nancy uses weneedavacation, which is focused on the Cape. Home away and VRBO mostly rent weekly rentals. Lynn received complaints about noise and churning of renters throughout the week. Nancy addressed the culture and stated that often AirBnB renters put too many people in the cottage and then they are gone in 2-3 days. Susan would like to make a recommendation to owners to institute a minimum length of stay this year and see how it goes. Vote- motion does not carry. Owners are strongly encouraged to get seven-day rentals

Tour Groups: Our neighbor, Jay Vivian, conducts small group tours of Corn Hill. Most recently he had a larger tour group that was part of a Truro Historical Society Tour. Owners expressed concern about the size of tour group. Trustees recommend that we limit tour group size to 15 or less people. Additionally, Owners need advance notice and Jay must reinforce that this is CHCCA is private property and Passed but not the once a month. **Action: Lynn will let Jay know of our decision**

Cottage Repairs Dates- there are discrepancies within the *Guidelines for Repairs and the Rules for Owners documents* specific to the timing of when repairs are permitted. **Action**: Laurie will lead a committee to address language discrepancy and make a spring report to trustees. Brice and Margaret will join committee.

Evening Quiet hours- Trustees made a recommendation to change quiet hours from 9PM to 30 minutes after sunset. The current policy is that evening quiet hours start at 9PM. There is a concern with the kids running around and disturbing others. Susan thinks that 30 minutes after sunset is too short and that children are exploring the beauty of the hill and that it is a safe space for kids to enjoy. Motion does not carry. Nancy asked if she has the right to say something and she was told yes. Use common sense. **Decision:** No change in Evening Quiet Hours.

Cottage Closing Dates: Background – prior to Peters Property Management (PPM) involvement there were 2 closing dates. All of the cottages except for cottages 18 and 19 closed at the earlier first dates typically in mid- October. Cottages 18 &19 closed at the end of November because they are on a separate water line and there is very little risk of frozen pipes/ plumbing issues. Since PPM (2013) we have had 2 closing dates: usually the end of October and the end of November. All owners had the opportunity to choose closing dates that suited their needs. In the fall of 2018 and during the 2019 spring opening the CHCCA experienced significant issues with plumbing and frozen pipes. PPM and Cape Quality Plumbing is mandating that we select one date as early in November as possible to close all cottages. PPM and Cape Cod Quality will not be responsible for any plumbing issues if we do not heed their advice. Discussion: Owners discussed several pathways that would allow cottages 18 &19 to stay open through November 30. A recommendation was made that on a pilot basis that we close all cottages on Nov.4 with the exception of cottages 18 &19. Cottages 18 and 18 would bear any incremental cost of closing their cottages on Nov 30. Motion carries. **Action:** Lynn to follow up with PPM to make this happen.

Winterization Committee- **Action:** Laurie will lead committee to better understand the requirements and costs associated with winterizing all 13 cottages. Liz will join the committee. Laurie to share findings in October 2020.

Commissioning CHCCA work via Peters- Lynn is responsible for the management and oversight of PPM specific to any CHCCA business. Any request to engage PPM on CHCCA business must be approved and managed via Lynn.

Peters Property Management Contract- PPM has not increased their rates since 2013. It is interesting that despite no rate increases our annual PPM costs have increased significantly year over year. **Action:** Lynn with Margaret's support with review historical invoices to determine the root cause of our increased PPM expenditures despite no increase in unit cost pricing. With PPM's October 2019 renewal the PPM rates have increased significantly. **Recommendation:** Trustees recommend that we look for alternatives to PPM for 2021. **Action**: Liz will lead a property manager search committee. Margaret and Damon will join the committee. **Discussion:** To help reduce 2020 PPM expenses a motion was made to reduce weekly inspections during the high season to bi weekly inspections. Brice voice concerned the liability if we were to reduce inspections. Motion did not carry.

Interlopers- more interlopers than usual this past year. Discussion: should we place a rope at the end of the driveway or increase signage to deter interlopers? Decision: Place three signs along driveway to deter interlopers. Owners are encouraged to speak to interlopers and reinforce that CHCCA is private property. **Action**: Lynn to obtain signs and work with Trustees on language.

Dog policy- Lynn reviewed current policy. **Discussion:** Should we change policy to accommodate owners that would like to bring dog during Labor date weekend, much discussion ensued. **Decision:** Pilot for FY 2020—Dogs will be allowed on CHCCA property from the Friday of Labor Day week-end through June 30. **Action:** Judy P to amend dog policy with "pilot': language.

Budget

Margaret reviewed the budget from last year and highlighted the reasons for the reserve depletion. Beach stairs and overage from cottage 5 roof replacement are the key drivers of the unfavorable reserve variance. Additionally, there was an unfavorable variance of 10K on special projects. Please see 2019 Budget and special projects report.

Discussion: There is a real need to beef up reserves. Owners discussed the pros and con of conducting any special projects in 2020. We should either suspend special projects or charge owners an assessment to cover the costs of the special projects: **Decision**: Owners will be assessed $250 to cover the costs of the special projects. The following projects were voted and prioritized to complete in 2020:

1) Railing for stairs to SLW $1500
2) Sensors for lights $200
3) Sand path nourishments $1000
4) Signs—Private property-no trespassing $100
5) Sign – parking areas: CHCCA parking only $100
6) Replace rotting window storage room?

All spending on special projects will be capped at $3250. The FY 2020 budget is projected to have a surplus of $4900. Owners voted to allocate the $4900 to reserves. FY 2020 Budget was approved (see attached document)

Additional New Business:

Sand Path Discussion: Susan thinks that the sand path nourishment should be part of maintenance. Lynn commented that from an Association perspective the sand path is closed. Lynn has proposed that we hire an independent consultant to make a recommendation on the sand path. Lynn will pay for the consultant to provide an objective unbiased perspective on whether CHCCA is doing harm to the dune by keeping the sand path open. **Decision**: Lynn will hire a consultant, Rachel P, Susan, and Nancy will assist in selecting the consultant to determine if keeping the sand path open presents an unnecessary hazard to our dune.

Flip Tax- Christine will investigate and report back.

Bunker House—motion was approved to donate $250.

Smoking on the Beach- After discussion it was determined that because smoking on the beach is allowed below the mean high water mark anyway, already, trying to restrict smoking on the beach above the mark would be kind of silly and hard to monitor so conclusion was to continue to allow people to smoke on the beach.

Alternative energy- Rachel and Liz will look at solar opportunities and report back in October 2020 option

Storage Room Clean up—Damon, Lynn, Jon, Rachel and Jerimiah volunteered to tackle the storage room. Others are welcome!

Reminders

- Leave fire extinguishers in storage room for inspection
- Check on Smoke detectors and Carbon Monoxide detectors
- Night lights—use them instead of leaving lights on all night.
- CHCCA close date is Nov. 4
- Margaret has a new address:
  - 975 Centre Street
  - Jamaica Plain, MA 02130
- (Not discussed at the meeting but Laurie has a new address: 8 Abigails Path, Plymouth 02360)

Meeting Evaluation:

- Nancy- meeting too long
- Adam- Hard to make it shorter
- Kate- once a year it was good
- Laurie- very effective.
- Christina- Voting is a bit messy
- Patty- you did a great job
- Margaret- good
- Liz – well run meeting
- Judy- know ahead about the voting stuff
- Brice- good job- laundry
- Susan- good. Address the budget earlier
- Jerimiah- long because of the substantial agenda- like the efficiency. Another meeting during the year.
- Rachel-blueberry thing was great
- Lynn- Wasn't our best meeting. Went way over. Got through it all. Good decisions. Good committees. Agreed to do it for one more year - It takes a lot of time. Invite others to run the meeting next time and/or encouraging anyone to step forward who may want to become new President.

2020 CHCCA Meeting Oct. 17, 2020 @ 9:30 am

Meeting adjourned at 1:20 PM